



Session Objectives

1. Associate leads with their anatomical position and arteries
2. Identify and interpret orientation, rate, rhythm, axis, and intervals on an ECG
3. Recognize normal and abnormal waves, intervals, and segments.

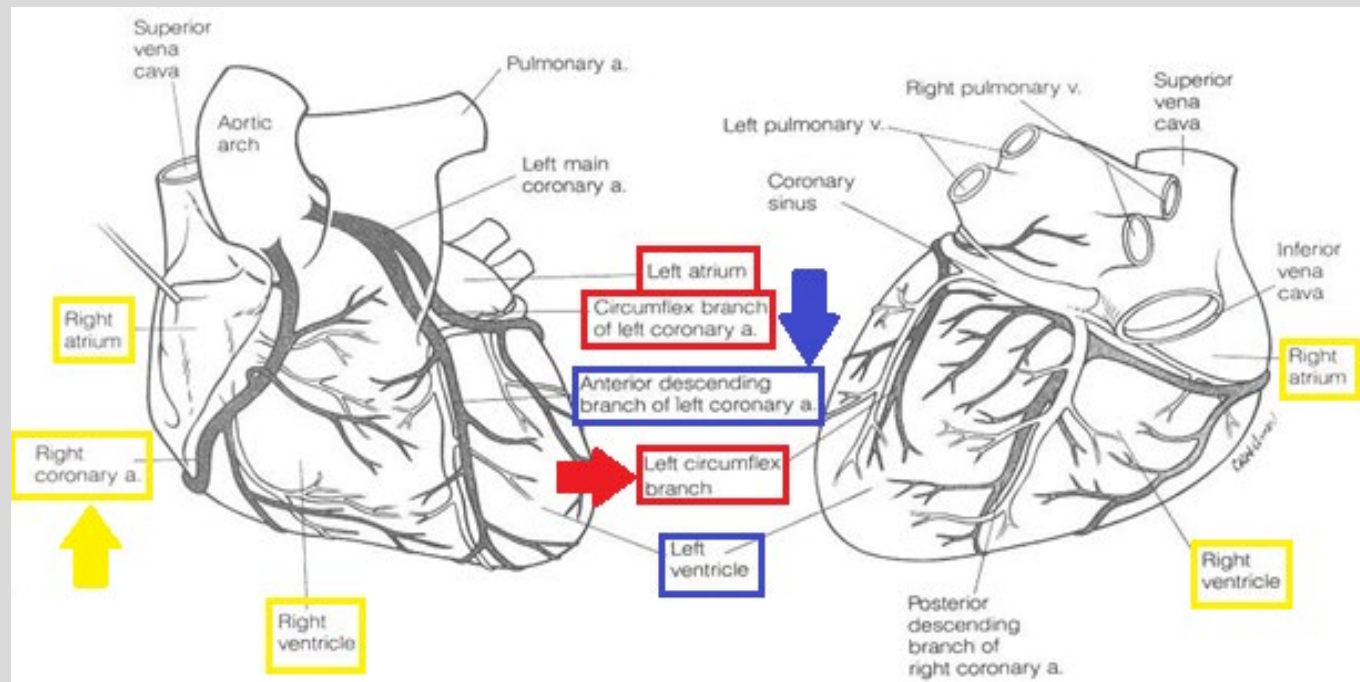
First Aid (2025): 288, 292, 298,
308,310

Source: Course Syllabus

Coronary Circulation

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Left Circumflex
Coronary Artery
“Lateral view”

Left Anterior
Descending Coronary
Artery
“Septal & Anterior
views”

Right Coronary Artery
“inferior view”



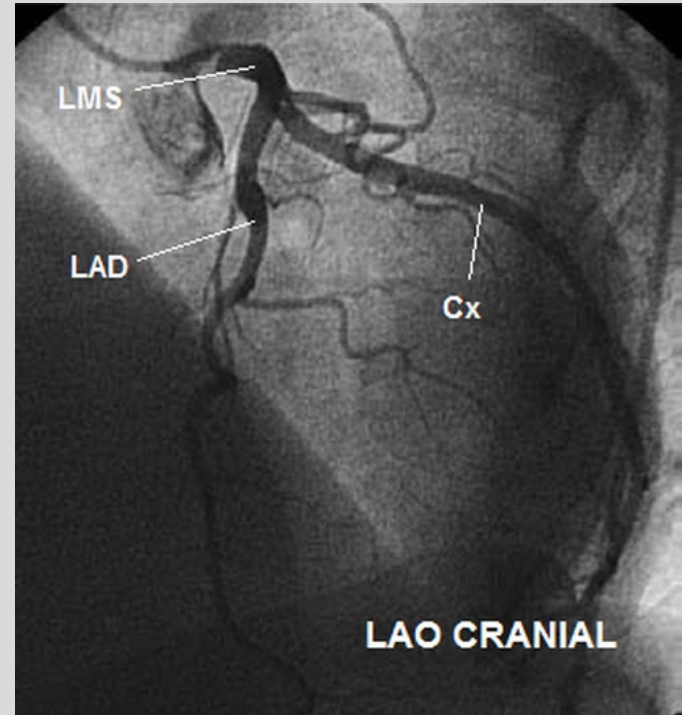
Angiography

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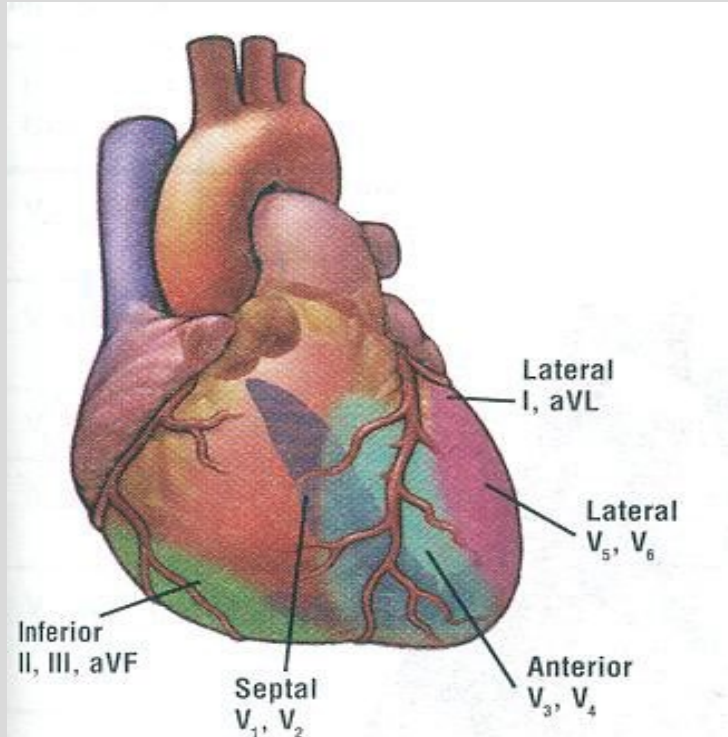


LMS stands for “left main stem”





Corresponding Leads*



Right Coronary Artery (RCA):

- **Inferior View**
- **II, III, aVF**

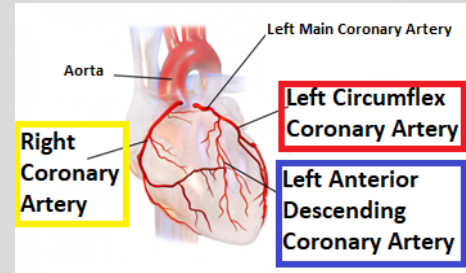
Left Anterior Descending Artery (LAD):

- **Septal and Anterior Views**
- **V1-V4**

Left Circumflex Artery (LCX):

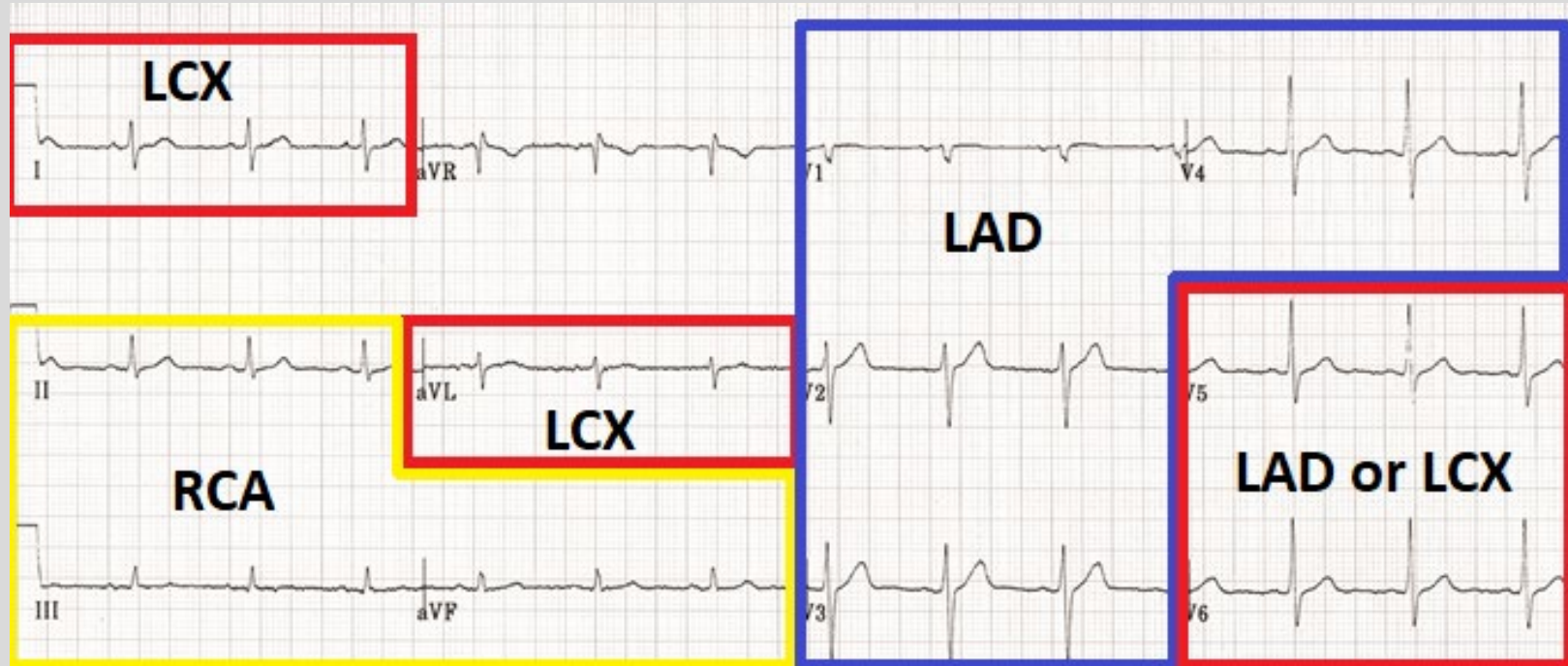
- **Lateral View**
- **V5, V6, aVL**

Corresponding Leads, Arteries, and Views



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Mnemonic for Views: “SALI”

S= septal; V1-V2 (LAD)

A= anterior; V3-V4 (LAD)

L= lateral; V5-V6, I, aVL (LCX/LAD)

I= inferior; II, III, aVF (RCA)





Objective 1 Questions

What of the following is not a correct correlation of cardiac view with leads?

LAD = V1-V4

RCA = II, III, aVF

LCX = V5-V6, I, aVL

none of the above



Objective 1 Questions

Pt presents with classic signs & sxs of an MI. On EKG, you find ST elevations in I & II. What do you diagnose?

Anterior STEMI

Inferior STEMI

Septal STEMI

Need more info to diagnose



Steps in Analyzing a 12-lead ECG

1. **Orient** yourself
2. Calculate **Rate**
3. Determine **Rhythm**
4. Determine the **Axis**
5. **Intervals** and QRS Duration
6. **“Others”** ST segment & T wave

Officer **R**yan **R**eynolds **A**lways **I**mpresses **O**thers

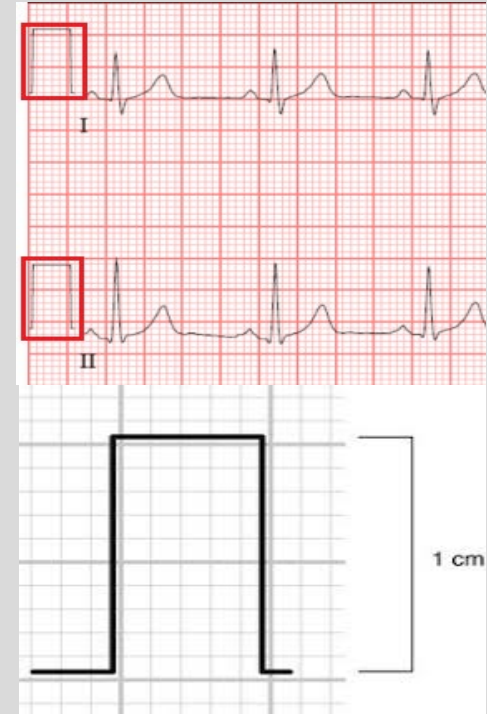


Reading an ECG is a developed skill! Find the steps that work best for you and apply them in the same order for every ECG you read.

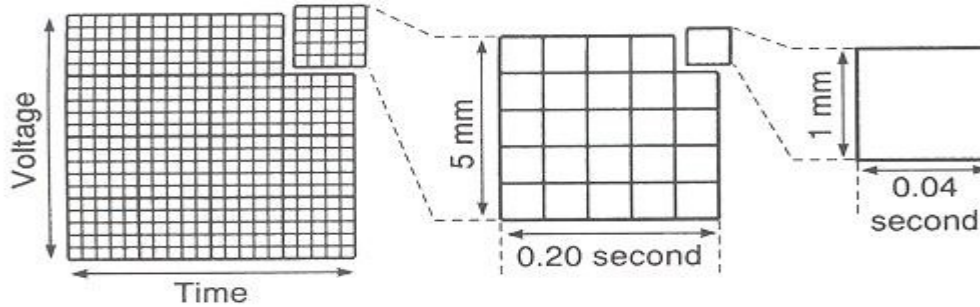


Orient Yourself

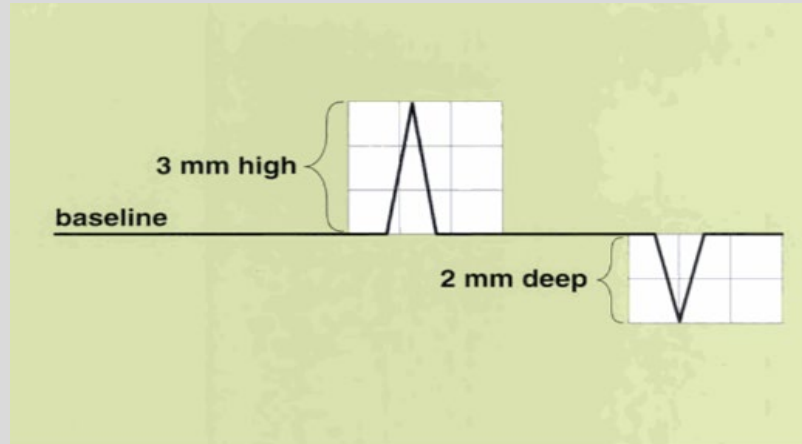
- Identify if this is a 12-lead or a rhythm strip
- Telemetry monitoring strips look very similar
- Check if the calibration is correct
 - Should be 2 boxes up and 1 box wide
- If you saw the patient note age, sex, body habitus
 - Thinner patients can have larger amplitudes
 - Obese patients can have smaller amplitudes



ECG Paper



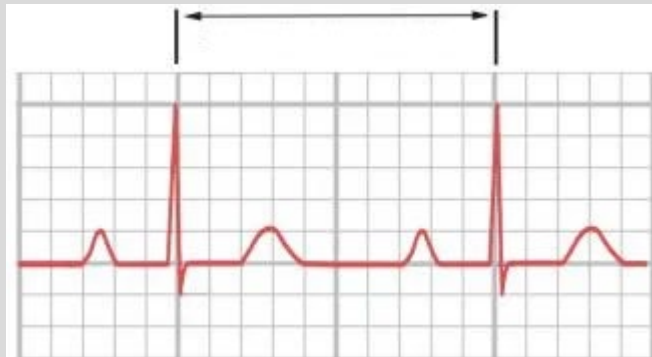
Horizontal axis = time
Vertical axis = voltage
1 small box = 0.04 seconds
1 large box = 5 small boxes
1 large box = 0.2 seconds





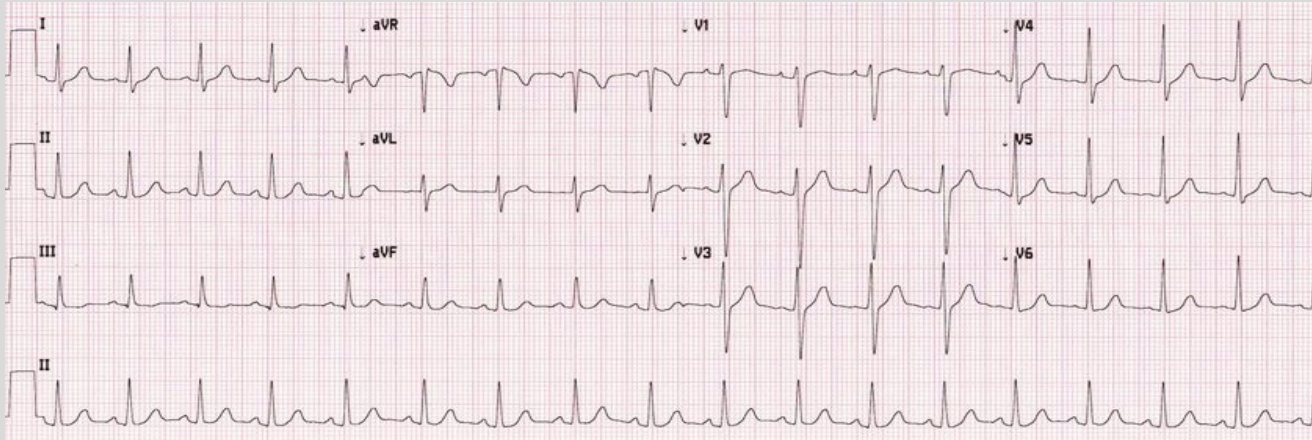
Calculate Rate (ct'd)

- Method 3: Count the number of big boxes between two QRS complexes and divide 300 by that number
 - Or 1500 divided by the number of small boxes
- Image below: 2 large boxes or 10 small boxes
 - $300/2$ or $1500/10$ gives a heart rate of 150 bpm





Calculate Rate (ct'd)



- Method 1: 18 QRS Complexes X 6 = 108
- Method 2: 3 squares in between QRS complexes (300 → 150 → 100) approximately 100 bpm
- Method 3: $300 / (2.9 \text{ large boxes}) = 103 \text{ bpm}$
 - $1500 / (14 \text{ small boxes}) = 108 \text{ bpm}$



Determine Rhythm (ct'd)

- Next step is to see if the rhythm is regular or irregular
- Easiest method is to take a separate piece of paper and mark the R wave on 3-4 QRS complexes
- Next slide this down the ECG strip
- If the distance between R waves remains the same the rhythm is regular
- If the distance changes between R waves on the strip the rhythm is irregular





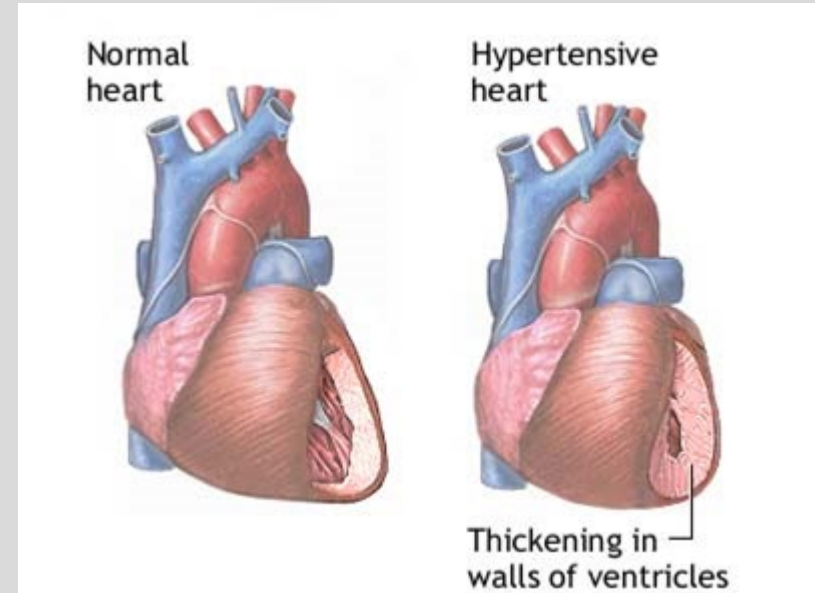
Causes of Axis Deviation

Right axis deviation:

- Right ventricular hypertrophy
- Anterolateral MI

Left Axis deviation:

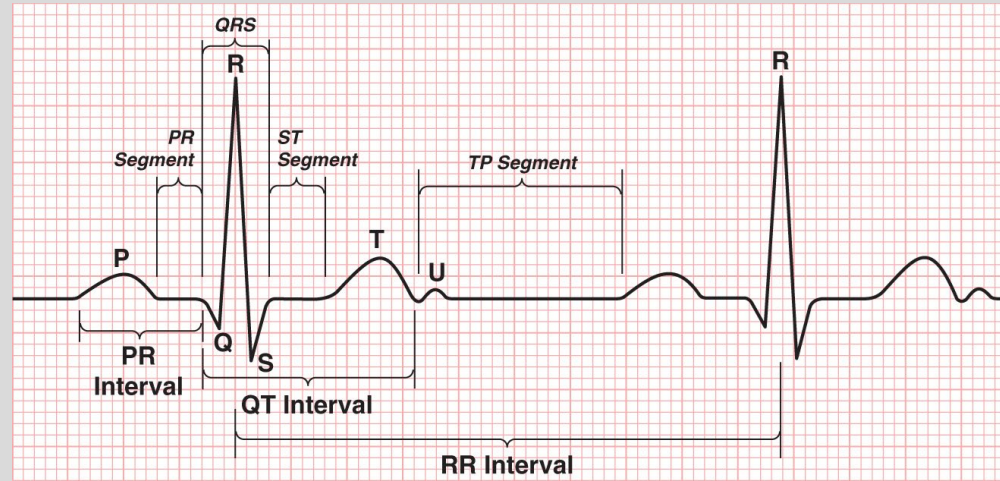
- Left Ventricular hypertrophy*
- Ventricular tachycardia
- Inferior MI





Measure the QRS duration

- Beginning at the start of the QRS to the end of the QRS
- Count the number of small boxes and multiple by 0.04
- Should be $< 120\text{ms}$
- A wide QRS can give important information on a patient's diagnosis





Summary Slide

- Right Coronary Artery (RCA): II, III, aVF
- Left Anterior Descending Artery (LAD): V1-V4
- Left Circumflex Artery (LCX): V5, V6, aVL
- **Analyzing an ECG**
 1. Orient yourself
 2. Calculate Rate (three methods)
 3. Determine Rhythm (look at p waves, R-R distance)
 4. Determine the Axis (+/- in I and aVF)
 5. Calculate Intervals and QRS duration (PR interval, QT interval)
 6. Look at the ST segment (ischemia) and T wave, compare changes to the TP segment



Objective 1: Associate leads with their anatomical position and associated arteries

- Review of coronary arteries
- Review of a STEMI; most common MI locations
- Leads correlate with specific arteries

Objective 2: Identify and interpret rate, rhythm, and axis of ECG strips

- Timing of the boxes
- Show multiple methods of finding rate
- Show rhythms - NSR, atrial fibrillation (longer method w 10 secs)
- Einthoven's triangle—> physiologic calculation of axis
- Thumbs up or thumbs down method of axis
- Causes of abnormal axis

Objective 3: Recognize normal and abnormal waves, intervals, and segments.

- Normal PR interval + abnormalities
- Normal QRS interval + abnormalities
- Normal QT interval + abnormalities
- Normal T wave + abnormalities
- Normal ST + abnormalities (STEMI)
 - transmural vs subendocardial